



ASIAN INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL
PRE-BOARD EXAMINATION - II
SUBJECT - ENGLISH LITERATURE AND LANGUAGE (184)
SESSION - 2025-26

MAXIMUM MARKS:80

CLASS:X

TIME:3 HRS

DATE: 14/01/2026

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS:

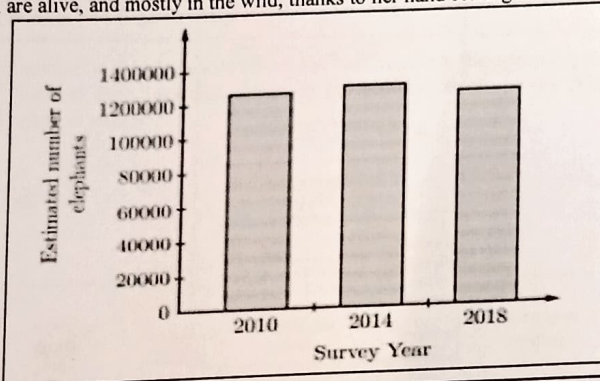
Read the instructions carefully and follow them:

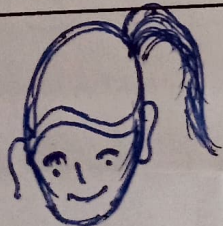
1. This question paper comprises 11 questions. All questions are compulsory.
2. The question paper contains THREE sections –
Section – A: Reading Skills
Section – B: Grammar and Creative Writing Skills
Section – C: Literature Textbook
3. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each Part.

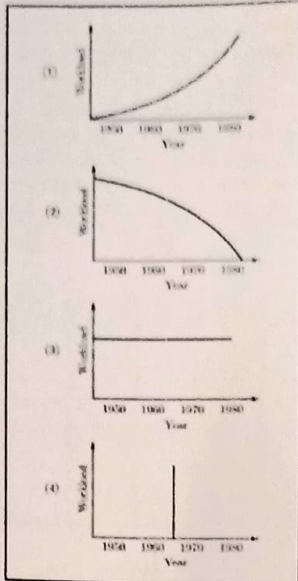
SECTION A: READING SKILLS (20 MARKS)
(Reading Comprehension Through Unseen Passages)

I.	Read the passage given below	[10]
1.	Located about 60 miles south of Baghdad in modern-day Iraq, the ancient city of Babylon served for nearly two millennia as a centre of Mesopotamian civilisation.	
2.	One of its early rulers, Hammurabi, created a harsh system of laws, while in later times, the Babylonian language would be used across the Middle East as a way of communicating across borders. Another great accomplishment, if the ancient stories are true, is the construction of the Hanging Gardens, a wonder of the ancient world, which some believe was built by the biblical king Nebuchadnezzar II.	
3.	The ancient scientists who lived in the city made important discoveries in mathematics, physics and astronomy. Among their many accomplishments, they developed trigonometry, used mathematical models to track the planet Jupiter and developed methods of tracking time that is still used today. Ancient Babylonian records are still used by modern-day astronomers to study how the rotation of the Earth has changed.	
4.	Archaeologically, little is known about the early history of Babylon. Ancient records suggest that more than 4,000 years ago, at a time when the city of Ur was the centre of an empire, Babylon appears to have been a provincial administration centre. "Babylon had not been an independent city," writes researcher Gwendolyn Leick in her book "The Babylonians".	
5. ✓	She notes that in 1894 B.C., after the Ur-based empire had collapsed, the city was conquered by a man named Samu-abum. He was an Amorite, a Semitic-speaking people from the area around modern-day Syria. He proceeded to turn Babylon into a petty kingdom made up of the city and a small amount of nearby territory. Babylon would remain this way until, six kings later, a man named Hammurabi (1792- 1750 B.C.) ascended the throne. He was the ruler who would go on to turn this once small kingdom into a great empire.	
6.	While the Law Code of Hammurabi (now in the Louvre) is well known for its "eye for an eye" style of lawmaking, it also sets out the nature of the relationship between Hammurabi, the gods and the people he ruled. Ultimately, Hammurabi's empire did not last, falling into decline after his death. In 1595 B.C., the Hittite ruler Mursili-I captured Babylon, bringing the rule of Hammurabi's successors to a close.	
	<i>(Created for academic usage/ 375 words)</i>	
	Based on your understanding of the passage, answer the questions given below.	[10*1]
i.	Choose the option that best captures the central idea of the passage from the given quotes. (a) "Civilisation is a limitless multiplication of unnecessary necessities." — Mark Twain (b) "The liberty of the individual is no gift of civilisation. It was greatest before there was any	[1]

	civilisation.” — Sigmund Freud (c) “The gross heathenism of civilisation has generally destroyed nature, and poetry, and all that is spiritual”. — Muir (d) “Each civilisation dies from indifference to the unique values which created it.” — Davila					
ii.	ii. Select the option that corresponds to the following relation below: He was the ruler who would go on to turn this once small kingdom into a great empire. (a) The government assisted in transforming micro-scale industries into large-scale industries. (b) Some people think that it's better to eat less than their appetite. (c) The vase had a very small neck and spread out at the top like a bowl. (d) The little girl has a miniature garden in her house.	[1]				
iii.	Read the following sentences : 1.Hammurabi created a harsh system of laws. 2.The Babylonian language would be used across the Middle East as a way of communicating across borders. 3.The collapse of the Ur-based empire. 4.Babylon becomes a petty kingdom made up of the city and a small amount of nearby territory. Which of the following options presents the correct order of the events? (a) 1, 2, 3, 4 (b) 3, 1, 4, 2 (c) 3, 4, 1, 2 (d) 3, 2, 4, 1	[1]				
iv.	Complete the following with a phrase or an idiom from Paragraph 6: <table border="1"><thead><tr><th>Opinion</th><th>Meaning</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td></td><td>Someone should be harmed as they harmed someone else</td></tr></tbody></table>	Opinion	Meaning		Someone should be harmed as they harmed someone else	[1]
Opinion	Meaning					
	Someone should be harmed as they harmed someone else					
v.	The writer uses two contrasting words in the line- Ancient Babylonian records are still used by modern-day astronomers to study how the rotation of the Earth has changed. - State what you mean by ancient and modern.	[1]				
vi.	Based on your reading of the text, list 2 reasons why the writer says that: “The ancient scientists who lived in the city made important discoveries”. 1. _____ 2. _____	[1]				
vii.	The writer says, “Babylon would remain this way until, six kings later, a man named Hammurabi (1792- 1750 B.C.) ascended the throne”. Select the reason of change of Babylon after the throne was ascended by Hammurabi. (a) He transformed a small kingdom into a great empire. (b) He was a ruthless leader. (c) He transformed a great empire into a small kingdom. (d) He was a fighter.	[1]				
viii.	The writer says, “Samu-abum proceeded to turn Babylon into a petty kingdom...” Why did the writer say so?	[1]				
ix.	Supply 1 point to justify the following: One of its early rulers, Hammurabi, created a harsh system of laws.	[1]				
x.	Choose the option that correctly states the two meanings of ‘close’, as used in paragraph 6. 1. adjacent 2. ended 3. near-at-hand 4. approaching 5. across the street (a) 1 and 4 (b) 2 and 3 (c) 3 and 5 (d) 4 and 5	[1]				

II.	Read the passage given below	[10]								
1.	Elephant babies like coconut oil. This discovery has saved the lives of hundreds of orphaned, unweaned elephants, left behind when their mothers were killed, victims of the ivory wars that have catastrophically reduced elephants' populations across Africa.									
2.	The discovery came after two decades of efforts by the renowned conservationist Daphne Sheldrick, who has died aged 83. She devoted most of her life to rescuing young elephants and releasing them back into the wild.									
3.	When she first made attempts to keep the orphaned babies alive, often at one or two years old, with other milk sources, they remained malnourished and faded into death. It was only after trying every combination she could find that she hit on one baby milk formula from Europe, which contained coconut oil that seemed to work. She and the elephants never looked back, and now more than 230 elephants in Kenya, and many others in Asia and other parts of Africa, are alive, and mostly in the wild, thanks to her hand-rearing.  <table border="1"> <caption>Estimated number of elephants</caption> <thead> <tr> <th>Survey Year</th> <th>Estimated number of elephants</th> </tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>2010</td> <td>1,250,000</td> </tr> <tr> <td>2014</td> <td>1,300,000</td> </tr> <tr> <td>2018</td> <td>1,250,000</td> </tr> </tbody> </table>	Survey Year	Estimated number of elephants	2010	1,250,000	2014	1,300,000	2018	1,250,000	
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4.	Her work grew from her care of orphaned elephants found by her husband, David Sheldrick, chief warden at the Tsavo National Park in Kenya in the 1960s. By the time her sanctuary was well-established, in the late 70s and 80s, each elephant had its own stall, as otherwise they would disturb one another, was bottle-fed every three hours, and was given blankets, raincoats and sunscreen as needed. A keeper slept with each animal under a year old, alternating lest the babies grow too dependent.									
5.	Often, the elephants arrived traumatised, having experienced the lethal violence and cruelty of poaching. It was crucial, in her view, to recognise their grief and help them to overcome it. "They are like humans, she told journalists. "You have to think in human terms. How does a child feel when it has lost its whole family and is suddenly in the hands of the enemy?"									
6.	Throughout her life, Sheldrick championed the ability of elephants to communicate and their capacity for feeling. Once, she recounted, a wrenched the tusks from a newly killed bull elephant and threw them into the jungle, before the eyes of the poachers.									
	(Adapted for academic usage-361 words approx)									
	Based on your understanding of the passage, answer the questions given below.	[10*1]								
i.	Infer one reason for the following, based on information in Paragraph 4. - <i>Each elephant had its own stall.</i>	[1]								
ii.	Select the appropriate option to fill in the blank. <i>While referring to the emotional side of the elephants, Sheldrick said that _____.</i> (a) They are babies (b) They are weak (c) They are like human beings (d) They are like women	[1]								
iii.	Complete the following analogy correctly with a word/phrase from Paragraph 2 <i>critical: crucial:: _____: eminent</i>	[1]								



iv.	Which of the following oils is linked to elephant babies? (a) Coconut oil (b) Palm oil (c) Almond oil (d) Olive oil	[1]
v.	Select the chart that appropriately represents the workload of the conservationist Daphne Sheldrick through the given years, as per Paragraph 4.  (a) Option 1 (b) Option 2 (c) Option 3 (d) Option 4	[1]
vi.	How was Daphne Sheldrick able to save the lives of the orphaned elephants? (a) By giving them a shelter (b) By giving them food (c) By giving them formula milk (d) By giving them medicines	[1]
vii.	Substitute the word ' <u>trying</u> ' with ONE WORD similar in meaning, in the following sentence from Paragraph 3: <i>It was only after <u>trying</u> every combination she could find that she hit on one baby milk formula from Europe, which contained coconut oil that seemed to work.</i>	[1]
viii.	Based on your reading of the text, list any 2 attempts made by Daphne Sheldrick to keep the orphaned elephant babies alive. 1. _____ 2. _____	[1]
ix.	List one reason why Daphne Sheldrick told journalists that " <i>You have to think in human terms</i> ".	[1]
x.	Select the option that titles paragraphs 4-6 appropriately, with reference to information in the text. (a) (1) National park and sanctuary, (2) Cruelty of poaching, (3) Deep sympathy (b) (1) Zoological park, (2) Poaching as an art, (3) Deep sympathy (c) (1) National park and sanctuary, (2) Concern for tigers, (3) Love for animals (d) (1) National park, (2) Passionate towards hunting, (3) Bird sanctuaries	[1]

SECTION B: GRAMMAR & CREATIVE WRITING SKILLS (20 MARKS)

(CREATIVE WRITING SKILLS-10 MARKS)

(Note: All details presented in the questions are imaginary and created for assessment purposes. All the names and addresses used in the questions are fictitious. Resemblance, if any, is purely coincidental.)

III.	Attempt <u>ANY ONE</u> from A and B given below.	[5]
A.	You are Amit Kapoor, resident of 43/9, Shyam Enclave, Delhi. You visited Manali with your family during the summer vacation. You had two double suites at Lake View resort. Your stay at the hotel fell far short of the description in the brochure. Write a letter of complaint to the Customer Service Department to refund for your hotel stay.	

OR

B.	The recent reports in the press about the growing incidence of bullying in schools have greatly disturbed you. Write a letter to the Editor of 'Education Plus' newspaper expressing your views on this problem and suggesting ways to solve it. Sign yourself as Mohan/Monica, a student of Arya Public School, New Delhi.	
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IV.	Attempt <u>ANY ONE</u> from A and B given below.	[5]
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A.	Tsering, of class X, is contesting for the post of Junior School Captain in the upcoming student council elections. Given below is her character traits' graphic, shared in the public domain, by the school counsellor, for the awareness of student voters, at school. All Tsering's peers have been asked to write a paragraph in about 120 words, analysing these traits, to either support or oppose her candidature. As one of her peers, write this analytical paragraph by selecting some of the traits that support your analysis. (You may begin like this : As a responsible student voter, I believe Tsering possesses/does not possess the necessary traits to be a School Captain. You may end like this: For these reasons, I believe she has/does not have the potential to be a good School Captain and I support/oppose her candidature.)	
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OR

B.	The following table shows that textbooks are cheaper than technological means, to promote education in a country like India. Analyse the table and write a paragraph in about 100-120 words. <table border="1" style="width: 100%; border-collapse: collapse;"> <thead> <tr> <th></th><th>Text Books</th><th>Digital Modules</th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>Content</td><td>₹ 100.25</td><td>₹ 150.23</td></tr> <tr> <td>Management</td><td>₹ 200</td><td>₹ 50</td></tr> <tr> <td>Device</td><td>₹ 00</td><td>₹ 30,000</td></tr> <tr> <td>Network</td><td>₹ 00</td><td>₹ 10,000</td></tr> <tr> <td>Teacher training</td><td>₹ 100</td><td>₹ 1000</td></tr> <tr> <td>Total</td><td>₹ 400.25</td><td>₹ 41,200.23</td></tr> </tbody> </table>		Text Books	Digital Modules	Content	₹ 100.25	₹ 150.23	Management	₹ 200	₹ 50	Device	₹ 00	₹ 30,000	Network	₹ 00	₹ 10,000	Teacher training	₹ 100	₹ 1000	Total	₹ 400.25	₹ 41,200.23	
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(GRAMMAR-10 MARKS)

V.	Attempt <u>ANY TEN</u> out of twelve from the following questions.	[10]															
i.	Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option to complete the sentence. <i>The director had come out of the office before I ____.</i> (a) arrived (b) arrive (c) was arrived (d) had arrived	[1]															
ii.	Read the conversation between a father and his son. Complete the sentence by reporting son's reply correctly. Father: How was the paper? Son: It was easy. <i>The father asked his son how the paper had been. Son replied that ____.</i>	[1]															
iii.	Select the correct option to fill in the blank for the given line. <i>I doubt, if it ____ be of any use telephoning them so late.</i> (a) would (b) could (c) should (d) might	[1]															
iv.	Select the option that identifies the error and supplies the correction for the following line: A pleasure in being outdoors is fundamental for human happiness. <table border="1"><thead><tr><th>Option No.</th><th>Error</th><th>Correction</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>(a)</td><td>being</td><td>be</td></tr><tr><td>(b)</td><td>A</td><td>The</td></tr><tr><td>(c)</td><td>is</td><td>are</td></tr><tr><td>(d)</td><td>in</td><td>at</td></tr></tbody></table>	Option No.	Error	Correction	(a)	being	be	(b)	A	The	(c)	is	are	(d)	in	at	[1]
Option No.	Error	Correction															
(a)	being	be															
(b)	A	The															
(c)	is	are															
(d)	in	at															
v.	Complete the given sentence by filling in the blank with the correct option: When he died, Ramanujan ____ behind 3 notebooks. (a) was leaving (b) had left (c) left (d) leaves	[1]															
vi.	Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the bracket. The furniture in his house ____ (look) impressive.	[1]															
vii.	Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the bracket, for the given portion of a letter: Dear Sir, This is with reference to committee's letter of recommendation that ____ (highlight) the nominations for 'Safe Residential Area' award for this current year.	[1]															
viii.	Abhilash and Neha had a conversation about the inauguration of Neha's Dance Academy. Report Abhilash's question. <i>Is your best friend helping you in this venture?</i>	[1]															
ix.	Read the dialogue between Shabnam and her mentor, Sara, regarding her summer internship programme. Sara: Why did you choose to participate in this internship programme? Shabnam: Ah! I am convinced this programme has the potential to enhance my abilities. Select the correct option to complete the reporting of the above dialogue. Sara asked Shabnam ____ in that internship programme. Shabnam sighed and exclaimed that she was convinced that the programme had the potential to enhance her abilities. A. Why to choose to participate B. to choose participation	[1]															

	C. about her choice to participate D. with her choice in participating					
x.	Fill the blank by choosing the correct option, to complete the concluding line of an issued circular by an Organisation, to its Managers. A copy of the plan is enclosed and _____ (that/ then/ this) may be communicated to all Team Leaders for compliance.	[1]				
xi.	Complete the line from a self-awareness song by filling in the blank with the correct option. The river runs through your veins The trees and mountains _____ your name The moon and stars watch over You're guiding your way back home To dream the night away. A. will call B. call C. had called D. calls	[1]				
xii.	Identify the error and supply a correction for the following note in a passenger's flight instruction manual: Note- Passengers will not reach the airport late in order to avoid a fine equivalent to 5% of the basic fare. Use the given format for your response. <table><tr><td>error</td><td>correction</td></tr><tr><td> </td><td> </td></tr></table>	error	correction			[1]
error	correction					

SECTION C: LITERATURE (40 MARKS)

VI.	Read the given extracts and answer the questions for <u>ANY ONE</u> of the two, given.	[5]
A.	<i>"When he saw those photos, Ebright didn't shout, 'Eureka!' or even, 'I've got it!' But he believed that, along with his findings about insect hormones, the photos gave him the answer to one of biology's puzzles: how the cell can 'read' the blueprint of its DNA. DNA is the substance in the nucleus of a cell that controls heredity. It determines the form and function of the cell. Thus, DNA is the blueprint for life. Ebright and his college roommate, James R. Wong, worked all that night drawing pictures and constructing plastic models of molecules to show how it could happen. Together they later wrote the paper that explained the theory."</i> (The Making of a Scientist)	[5*1]
i.	State any one inference about Dr Urquhart with reference to the text: "Everyone assumed the spots were just ornamental," Ebright said. "But Dr Urquhart didn't believe it."	[1]
ii.	State TRUE or FALSE. None of the terms (a) -(d) below can be applied to the question: What is the purpose of the twelve tiny gold spots on a monarch pupa? (a) A hypothesis - a proposed explanation for a phenomenon (b) An assumption - something that is taken for granted or assumed to be true without proof (c) A premise - a proposition that forms the basis of an argument (d) A theory - a well-substantiated explanation for a natural phenomenon	[1]
iii.	Ebright's approach towards finding the purpose of the gold spots on a monarch pupa was highly effective. Elaborate in about 30 words, with reference to the extract.	[1]
iv.	Which phrase would correctly substitute '<u>a chance</u>' in the given sentence from the extract? He also got <u>a chance</u> to work during the summer at the entomology laboratory of the Walter Reed Army Institute	[1]

	of Research.	
v.	"Thus, DNA is the blueprint for life", is another way of saying that the DNA contains a genetic _____. A. experiment B. ultimatum C. takeaway D. plan	[1]
OR		
B.	"CHUBUKOV: Who's dead? [Looks at Lomov] So he is! My word! Water! A doctor! [Lifts a tumbler to Lomov's mouth] Drink this! No, he doesn't drink. It means he's dead, and all that. I'm the most unhappy of men! Why don't I put a bullet into my brain? Why haven't I cut my throat yet? What am I waiting for? Give me a knife! Give me a pistol! [Lomov moves] He seems to be coming round. Drink some water! That's right. LOMOV: I see stars... mst... where am I? CHUBUKOV: Hurry up and get married and — well, to the devil with you! She's willing! [He puts Lomov's hand into his daughter's] She's willing... I give you my blessing and so on. Only leave me in peace!" (The Proposal)	[5*1]
i.	Which of the following is NOT a reason why Lomov thinks he must marry? A. He is already 35 years old. B. He suffers from palpitations. C. He is excitable and easily upset. D. He is in love with Natalya.	[1]
ii.	Why is it fair to say that Lomov's tone, when he says "What more do I want?" is uncertain and questioning? Answer in about 30 words.	[1]
iii.	Read the following descriptions (a)-(c) and identify which one correctly corresponds to the extract. (a) A debate is a formal discussion on a particular topic, usually with two or more people presenting different viewpoints and arguments. (b) A soliloquy is a speech given by a character alone on stage, which reveals their innermost thoughts and feelings to the audience. (c) An aside is a brief comment or remark made by a character directly to the audience, which is not intended to be heard by other characters on stage	[1]
iv.	As per the text, what did Chubukov think that Lomov had come for?	[1]
v.	Find the phrase from the given extract which matches the description. - <i>"To be dazed or rendered unconscious by a blow to the head, sometimes perceiving actual flashing lights as a result"</i>	[1]
VII.	Read the given extracts and answer the questions for <u>ANY ONE</u> of the two, given.	[5]
A.	<i>But if it had to perish twice, I think I know enough of hate To say that for destruction ice Is also great And would suffice.</i> (Fire and Ice)	[5*1]
i.	Fill the blank with <u>one</u> word. When the speaker says that ice could also bring about the end of the world, he refers to _____, as the means for destruction.	[1]
ii.	What does the speaker's alignment with those who favour ice suggest?	[1]
iii.	Which of the following best describes the speaker's attitude towards the destruction caused by ice? A. Indifferent B. Fearful	[1]

	C. Dismissive D. Respectful	
iv.	What does 'ice' symbolise here in the extract? A. Desire B. Fear C. Hatred D. Love	[1]
v.	Identify the figure of speech used to signify 'Ice' here in the given poem. A. Allusion B. Oxymoron C. Metaphor D. Personification	[1]

OR

B.	<i>The fog comes On little cat feet. It sits looking over harbour and city on silent haunches And then moves on.</i> (Fog)	[5*1]
i.	In what way does the language used in this poem challenge traditional ideas of what poetry should be?	[1]
ii.	What is the significance of the use of the word "little" to describe the fog in the poem, and how does this word choice contribute to the overall mood and tone of the poem? Answer in about 30 words.	[1]
iii.	Complete the sentence with the appropriate option. The lines from the poem tell us that the city is _____. A. hilly B. coastal C. industrial D. under-developed	[1]
iv.	Identify the type of imagery used in the lines of the poem.	[1]
v.	Bring out the expression of the line ' <i>The fog comes on little cat feet</i> ' as used in the extract.	[1]
VIII.	Answer <u>ANY FOUR</u> of the following five questions, in about 40-50 words.	[4*3=12]
i.	Justify the opinion that the traditional baker and his bread play a significant role in the cultural and social fabric of Goan society. (Glimpses of India-I)	[3]
ii.	How does Leslie Norris use vivid imagery and metaphorical language in <i>A Tiger in the Zoo</i> , to effectively depict the confinement and oppression experienced by the captive tiger?	[3]
iii.	Explain how the description of the devastation caused by the hailstorm reflects the sadness within Lencho in <i>A Letter to God</i> ? Refer to the given lines from the text: <i>"Not a leaf remained on the trees. The corn was destroyed. The flowers were gone from the plants. Lencho's soul was filled with sadness."</i>	[3]
iv.	<i>"Kitty was a trusted friend to Anne"</i> – elucidate with reference to the text From <i>the Diary of Anne Frank</i> .	[3]
v.	How does Ogden Nash's <i>The Tale of Custard the Dragon</i> , challenge the notion that individuals should conform to societal expectations?	[3]

		[3*2=6]
IX.	Answer <u>ANY TWO</u> of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words.	
i.	The story, <i>A Triumph of Surgery</i> is a powerful example of the importance of saying "no". Explain.	[3]
ii.	How does education play a transformative role in Bholi's life? (Bholi)	[3]
iii.	Why does Mrs Pumphrey think the dog's recovery is a triumph of surgery in the story ' <i>A Triumph of Surgery</i> '?	[3]
X.	Answer <u>ANY ONE</u> of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words.	[6*1]
i.	Humour is the best medicine for every ailment in life. Is the poem humorous? Give reasons for your answer. (How to Tell Wild Animals)	[6]

OR

ii.	"Freedom is indivisible; the chains on any one of my people were the chains on all of them, the chains on all of my people were the chains on me." How does Nelson Mandela come to realise this? (Nelson Mandela: A Long Walk to Freedom)	[6]
XI.	Answer <u>ANY ONE</u> of the following two questions, in about 100-120 words.	[6*1]
i.	A character arc is the transformation or development of a character throughout a story and refers to the changes a character undergoes as a result of their experiences, challenges, and interactions with other characters. In light of the above information, trace the character arc of the thief in Ruskin Bond's <i>The Thief's Story</i> , in about 120 words.	[6]

OR

ii.	"We are too involved in materialistic things, and they don't satisfy us. The loving relationships we have, the universe around us, we take these things for granted." Mitch Albom Matilda was never satisfied with her life and desired more. The given quote reflects her character. Justify the statement with reference to the text <i>The Necklace</i> .	[6]
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